

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
North Coast Region

ORDER NO. 96-11
ID NO. 1B710110SON

WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS

FOR

THE SONOMA COUNTY WATER AGENCY, COUNTY SERVICE AREA #6
SEA RANCH CENTRAL WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITIES

Sonoma County

The California Regional Water Quality Control Board, North Coast Region, (hereinafter the Regional Water Board) finds that:

1. On January 25, 1996, the Sonoma County Water Agency submitted a complete report of waste discharge for revision of waste discharge requirements for the Sea Ranch Central, Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities. The Sonoma County Water Agency, County Service Area #6 shall hereinafter be referred to as the discharger.
2. The Sea Ranch Central Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities are owned and operated by the discharger to provide wastewater treatment and disposal for the central portion of The Sea Ranch subdivision on the Northern Sonoma County Coast. The location of these facilities is shown on Attachment A to this Order.
3. The Sea Ranch Central Wastewater Treatment Plant is designed to provide secondary treatment for up to 27,000 gallons of wastewater per day, average dry weather flow. Treatment consists of an aerated pond followed by filtration and disinfection prior to being discharged to a 1.74 million gallon storage pond. Water from the storage pond is discharged to a 10 acre irrigation field (only 4 acres of this field are currently under irrigation). A flow schematic of the Sea Ranch Central Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities is shown on Attachment B to this Order. Solids are reduced to an insignificant volume in the aerated pond.
4. The Regional Water Board Water Quality Control Plan for the North Coast Region includes water quality objectives, implementation plans for point source and nonpoint source discharges and statewide plans and policies.
5. The beneficial uses of unnamed coastal streams adjacent to the Sea Ranch Central Wastewater Treatment and Disposal Facilities include:

- a. water contact recreation
 - b. non-contact water recreation
 - c. cold freshwater habitat
 - d. wildlife habitat
6. The beneficial uses of areal groundwater include:
 - a. domestic water supply
 - b. agricultural supply
7. The discharge is presently governed by Waste Discharge Requirements, Order No. 86-99, adopted by the Regional Water Board on June 27, 1986.
8. This project consists of the operation or minor alteration of an existing facility which involves minimum expansion or change in use beyond that previously existing, and is, therefore, exempt from the requirements of the California Environmental Quality Act under Section 15301 of the Resources Agency Guidelines.
9. The Regional Water Board has notified the discharger and interested agencies and persons of its intent to prescribe waste discharge requirements for the discharge and has provided them with an opportunity to submit their written comments and recommendations.
10. The Regional Water Board, in a public meeting, heard and considered all comments pertaining to the discharge.

THEREFORE, IT IS HEREBY ORDERED that Waste Discharge Requirements, Order No. 86-99 are rescinded and the discharger, in order to meet the provisions contained in Division 7 of the California Water Code and regulations adopted thereunder, shall comply with the following:

A. DISCHARGE PROHIBITIONS

1. The discharge of any waste not specifically regulated by this Order is prohibited.
2. Creation of a pollution, contamination, or nuisance, as defined by Section 13050 of the California Water Code (CWC), is prohibited. [Health and Safety Code, Section 5411]
3. The discharge of untreated waste from anywhere within the collection, treatment, or disposal facilities is prohibited.
4. The discharge of waste to the Pacific Ocean or its tributaries is prohibited.

B. EFFLUENT LIMITATIONS

1. Wastes discharged to the treated wastewater storage pond shall not contain constituents in excess of the following limits:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>30-Day Average¹</u>	<u>Daily Maximum</u>
BOD (20°C, 5-day)	mg/l	30	60
Nonfilterable Residue	mg/l	30	60
Total Coliform			
Organisms	MPN/100 ml	23 ²	230
Hydrogen Ion	pH	Not less than 6.0 or greater than 9.0	

2. The mean daily dry weather flow of waste to the Sea Ranch Central Wastewater Treatment Plant shall not exceed 27,000 gallons per day averaged over a period of 30 consecutive days.

C. SOLIDS DISPOSAL

1. Collected screenings, sludges, and other solids removed from liquid wastes shall be disposed of at a legal point of disposal, and in accordance with the provisions of Title 23, Division 3, Chapter 15 of the California Code of Regulations.

D. PROVISIONS

1. A copy of this Order shall be maintained at the discharge facility and be available at all times to operating personnel.
2. Severability

Provisions of these waste discharge requirements are severable. If any provision of these requirements is found invalid, the remainder of these requirements shall not be affected.

3. Operation and Maintenance

The discharger must maintain in good working order and operate as efficiently as possible any facility or control system installed by the discharger to achieve compliance with these waste discharge requirements.

¹ The arithmetic mean of the values for effluent samples collected in a period of 30 consecutive days

² Monthly median

4. Change in Discharge

The discharger must promptly report to the Regional Water Board any material change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.

5. Change in Ownership

In the event of any change in control or ownership of land or waste discharge facilities presently owned or controlled by the discharger, the discharger must notify the succeeding owner or operator of the existence of this Order by letter, a copy of which must be forwarded to the Regional Water Board.

6. Vested Rights

This Order does not convey any property rights of any sort or any exclusive privileges. The requirements prescribed herein do not authorize the commission of any act causing injury to persons or property, nor protect the discharger from his liability under federal, State, or local laws, nor create a vested right for the discharger to continue the waste discharge.

7. Monitoring

The discharger must comply with the Contingency Planning and Notification Requirements Order No. 74-151 and the Monitoring and Reporting Program No. 96-11 and any modifications to these documents as specified by the Executive Officer. Such documents are attached to this Order and incorporated herein. Chemical, bacteriological, and bioassay analyses must be conducted at a laboratory certified for such analyses by the State Department of Health Services. In the event a certified laboratory is not available to the discharger, analyses performed by a noncertified laboratory will be accepted provided:

- a. A quality assurance/quality control program is instituted by the laboratory. A manual containing the steps followed in this program must be kept in the laboratory and available for inspection by staff of the Regional Water Board. The quality assurance/quality control program must conform to EPA guidelines or procedures approved by the Regional Water Board.
- b. The laboratory will become certified within the shortest practicable time if the State Certification Program is resumed.

8. Inspections

The discharger shall permit authorized staff of the Regional Water Board:

- a. entry upon premises in which an effluent source is located or in which any required records are kept;
- b. access to copy any records required to be kept under terms and conditions of this Order;
- c. inspection of monitoring equipment or records; and
- d. sampling of any discharge.

9. Noncompliance

In the event the discharger is unable to comply with any of the conditions of this Order due to:

- a. breakdown of waste treatment equipment;
- b. accidents caused by human error or negligence; or
- c. other causes such as acts of nature;

the discharger must notify the Executive Officer by telephone as soon as he or his agents have knowledge of the incident and confirm this notification in writing within two weeks of the telephone notification. The written notification shall include pertinent information explaining reasons for the noncompliance and shall indicate what steps are being taken to prevent the problem from recurring.

10. Revision of Requirements

The Regional Water Board requires the discharger to file a report of waste discharge at least 120 days before making any material change or proposed change in the character, location, or volume of the discharge.

11. Operator Certification

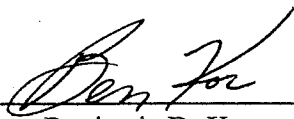
Supervisors and operators of municipal wastewater treatment plants shall possess a certificate of appropriate grade in accordance with Title 23, California Code of Regulations, Section 3680. The State Water Board may accept experience in lieu of qualification training. In lieu of a properly certified wastewater treatment plant operator, the State Water Board may approve the use of a water treatment plant operator of appropriate grade certified by the State Department of Health Services where reclamation is involved.

12. Adequate Capacity

Whenever a publicly owned wastewater treatment plant will reach capacity within four years, the discharger shall notify the Regional Water Board. A copy of such notification shall be sent to appropriate local elected officials, local permitting agencies, and the press. The discharger must demonstrate that adequate steps are being taken to address the capacity problem. The discharger shall submit a technical report to the Regional Water Board showing how flow volumes will be prevented from exceeding capacity, or how capacity will be increased, within 120 days after providing notification to the Regional Water Board, or within 120 days after receipt of Regional Water Board notification, that the POTW will reach capacity within four years. The time for filing the required technical report may be extended by the Regional Water Board. An extension of 30 days may be granted by the Executive Officer, and longer extensions may be granted by the Regional Water Board itself. (CCR Title 23, Section 2232)

Certification

I, Benjamin D. Kor, Executive Officer, do hereby certify that the foregoing is a full, true, and correct copy of an Order adopted by the California Regional Water Quality Control Board, North Coast Region, on March 28, 1996.



Benjamin D. Kor
Executive Officer

California Regional Water Quality Control Board
North Coast Region

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. 96-11

FOR

THE SONOMA COUNTY WATER AGENCY, COUNTY SERVICE AREA NO. 6
SEA RANCH CENTRAL WASTEWATER TREATMENT AND DISPOSAL FACILITIES

Sonoma County

MONITORING

Influent Monitoring

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
Flow (Mean and Peak)	gpd	Continuous	Daily

Monitoring the Discharge to the Storage Pond

Treated wastewater shall be sampled at a point prior to its entrance into the irrigation storage pond. Composite samples may be taken by a proportional sampling device approved by the Executive Officer or by grab samples composited in proportion to the flow. In compositing grab samples, the sampling interval shall not exceed one hour. The following shall constitute the monitoring program:

<u>Constituent</u>	<u>Units</u>	<u>Type of Sample</u>	<u>Sampling Frequency</u>
BOD (20°C, 5-day)	mg/l	8-hour composite	Weekly
Nonfilterable Residue	mg/l	8-hour composite	Weekly
Total Coliform			
Organisms	MPN/100 ml	grab	Weekly
Hydrogen Ion	pH	grab	Weekly
Chlorine Residual	mg/l	grab	Daily
Mean Daily Flow	gpd	Continuous	Daily

The discharger shall measure and record the depth of water, in feet and inches, in the storage pond on a daily basis.

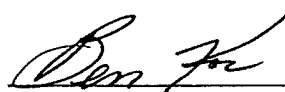
When discharging to the irrigation field, the discharger shall record the volume (in gallons) of stored water discharged to the irrigation field on a daily basis.

REPORTING

Monitoring reports shall be submitted monthly by the 15th day of the following month. In reporting the monitoring data, the discharger shall arrange the data in tabular form to clearly illustrate compliance with the waste discharge requirements.

In addition to the above, the discharger shall have all flow measuring devices tested annually and their accuracy certified. This certification shall be submitted with the annual monitoring report which is to be submitted by January 30, each year.

Ordered by



Benjamin D. Kor
Executive Officer

March 28, 1996